medium term, they nonetheless will continue to expect more from cooperation with the United States.

Balancing Between the BRICS and the West

This section has argued that Brazil's political leaders viewed their participation in BRICS financial statecraft, and in the BRICS club more generally, through the prism of Brazil-specific attitudes, perceptions, and concerns. These prominently have included Brazilian foreign policy traditions of diplomatic, rather than military, responses to international crises ("nonintervention"), neutrality ("universalism"), and the use of South-South coalitions and clubs among middle powers ("soft-balancing") to acquire greater international voice and autonomy. The NDB consistently is described in Brazil as equally committed to infrastructure financing and sustainable development.[264] This may be wishful thinking on the part of Brazilians, but it is consistent with other aspects of their generally idealistic foreign policy, which for example leads them to be scrupulous in referring to their foreign aid activities as "development cooperation," implying more equal bilateral relations than development "assistance" or "aid."

Brazilian participation in BRICS financial statecraft was also convenient for the incumbent center-left governments in power from early 2003 to mid-2016, as the sometimes anti-Western rhetoric of the club as a whole pleased parts of the PT political base who were dissatisfied with relatively centrist macroeconomic policies. However, Brazil's commitment to the BRICS club is not especially deep, at least partly because its dissatisfactions with global economic governance as dominated by the G7 or G5 major Western powers have more to do with status issues than with substantive disagreements. Finally, Brazil has increasingly close financial and economic relations with China, yet already has suffered disappointments with this relationship and will be eager to avoid becoming too dependent.[265]

THE VIEW FROM PRETORIA: SUPPORT FOR GROWTH AND REGIONAL LEADERSHIP

Since its 1994 pacted political transition from its racially-based apartheid regime, South African foreign policy primarily has focused on its region, defined variously as Southern Africa, sub-Saharan Africa, and the African continent as a whole. One theme, popular within the country and with virtually all its neighbors, has been anticolonial and antiimperialist